Finishing and Polishing of Complete Denture

Finishing:-

Finishing the complete denture consist of perfecting the final form of the denture by removing any flash (excess) of acrylic resin at the denture border, any flash and stone remaining around the teeth and any nodules of acrylic resin on the surfaces of the denture base resulting from processing.

The flash:-

Is the acrylic resin that was forces out between the halves of the flask by the pressure applied during the processing procedure.

Procedure of finishing:-

1. To remove the flash of acrylic resin from the denture border, press the denture base lightly against a slowly revolving arbor band mounted on the lathe. An alternative but less satisfactory to use a large acrylic or stone bur mounted in a straight hand piece to remove the excess resin. Take care not change the form of

denture border but only remove the excess resin on the border of denture.

fig1
removing excess acrylic with straight hand piece

2. Carefully remove any flash and any remaining stone from around the neck of teeth with a small sharp pick or sharp knife.

Fig2 remaining stone around the neck of the teeth

3. Remove any nodules of acrylic resin with small stone or acrylic carbide burs that are made for denture finishing. An alternative but less satisfactory to use a large acrylic or stone bur in a straight dental hand piece.

4. The posterior area of the palate has thinned to its proper thickness.

The grinding and cutting instruments:-

1. Acrylic carbide burs 2. Acrylic stone burs 3. Fissure burs.

4. Rubber wheels 5. Sand paper.

Polishing:-

Is a process of removing scratches with finer scratches. Polishing the dentures consist of making the dentures smooth and glossy without changing the contours.

Fig3 polished denture

Principles of polishing:-

1. The tissue surface of a denture is never polished as a polishing destroys the details necessary for good fit and retention.

2. The polished surface extends just over the border, but the borders are not reduced in height or width during polishing.

3. Care must be taken when using pumice (used as wet slurry) as this material is very abrasive and may obliterate the details placed on denture when they were waxed.

fig4 wet slurry pumice

4. Resin teeth have approximately the same hardness as the denture base, so polishing a denture with resin teeth requires some precautions not necessary with porcelain teeth.

5. When polishing, only the denture base and not the teeth are polished.

6. During the finishing and polishing we should minimize the reduction of bulk because this is cause warpage.

Procedure of polishing:-

1. Smooth the labial, buccal, lingual and palatal external surfaces of the denture with wet pumice on a rag wheel running at slow speed, keep plenty of pumice on the denture surface and keep the denture moving at all time, press the denture lightly against the wheel.

2. Polish the resin around the teeth with pumice and a brush wheel moving at slow speed, be careful not remove previously developed contours.

3. Wet muslin buffing wheel is used to polish the border, lateral and palatal surfaces of denture.

4. Felt cones or small buff wheels may be used to polish the palatal portion of the upper denture. The choice of wheels or cones dependent on the shape of the palate.

5. If stippling is desired in the denture base and was not placed during the final waxing it can be added at this time using small round bur lightly stipple the denture base from the second

premolar to the second premolar on the other side. Lightly pumice the stippling with a brush wheel at low speed.

6. Next stage use of Tripoli (greasy material). This material is applied to dry muslin buffing wheel, this differs in that the polishing compound is applied to the wheel and not as pumice to the piece of work being polished.

7. After the denture completely polished with Tripoli, it is scrubbed thoroughly.

8. Final polished is placed on the denture with a (high shine) material.

9. Store the polished dentures in water until they have been delivered to the patient with high gloss, compatible contour, and natural appearance. Store the dentures in water all the time otherwise it will go under dimensional changes and shrinkage.

Every new set of complete denture should be tested in mouth for tissue adaptation and retention and any pressure area or over extended borders should be indicated by using pressure indicated paste. Following that the dentist should be routinely remount the

dentures on the articulator from new centric relation record, making necessary correction before the patient is permitted to wear them home. This procedure created to correct any slight processing shrinkage of denture base, any tissue change or error in the impressions and occlusal discrepancies. Shortcuts should be avoided which will diminish the quality of the end product.

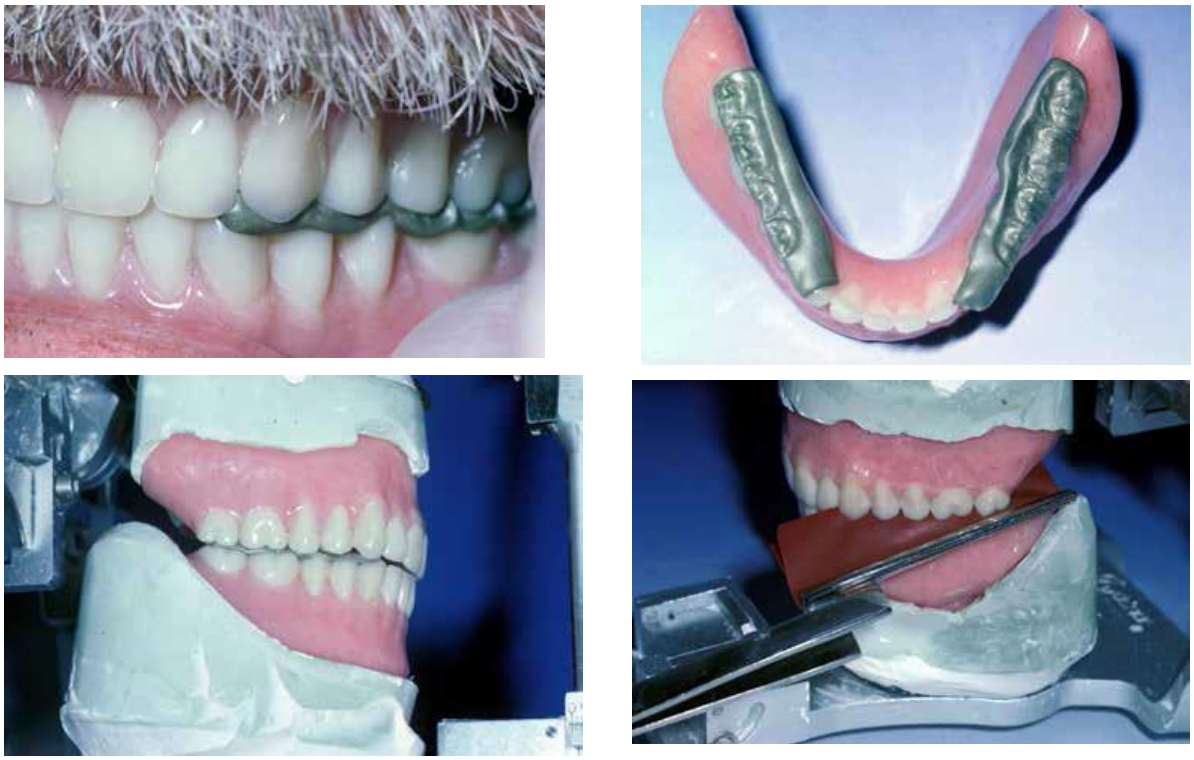

Fig5
steps of remounting dentures on the articulator from new centric relation record